

- Use a .REG file.

Consider a .REG file to be a set of instructions for making changes to the Windows Registry. Everything in it outlines what adjustments should be made to the registry's existing state.

In other words, any changes between the .REG file being run and the Windows Registry will result in the addition or removal of the entries and values in question.

Example .REG File

Let's explore this with a simple example, here are the contents of a basic 3-line .REG file that adds value to a specific registry key. The purpose of this scenario is to add the data required for the traditional bogus Blue Screen of Death:

```
Windows Registry Editor Version 5.00
[HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE\SYSTEM\CurrentControlSet\Services\
kbdhid\Parameters]
"CrashOnCtrlScroll"=dword:00000001
```

By default, the CrashOnCtrlScroll value isn't in the registry. You could use Registry Editor to manually create it, or you could write the instructions in a .REG file and have them added automatically.

Another way to think of these files is as tools for editing the registry. When performing the same registry modifications on many computers, you can save a lot of time. Simply write a single .REG file with the modifications you wish to make and apply it to many PCs at the same time.

Open, Edit, and Make your own .REG Files

These are files that are text-based. You can plainly see the numbers, path, and characters that make up the sample above if you look at it again. This means you can open one and read and edit everything in it with nothing more than a text editor.

The text editor included with Windows is Windows Notepad. By right-clicking or tapping-and-holding the file and selecting Edit, you can utilise that programme with a .REG file.

You can use Windows Notepad every time you need to read or modify the file if you like, but if you plan on working with these files frequently, there are alternative free text editing applications that are easier to use.

Because .REG files are simply text files, any text editor can be used to create a new one from the ground up.